

PROJECT PLANNING PHASE

1. Project Identification

Project Name: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Team ID: SWTID-2026-6530

Team Size: 5

Project Area: IT Procurement Automation

2. Brainstorming and Idea Listing

S.No	Team Member	Idea / Suggestion	Category
1	K. Nagajothi	Automate standard laptop procurement workflow	IT Automation
2	M. Pavithra	Automatically create catalog tasks after approval	Workflow Automation
3	D. Thailnayagi	Automatically assign laptop configuration tasks to Hardware team	Task Assignment
4	M. Nachammai	Use Flow Designer to reduce manual intervention	Process Automation
5	A. Rajathi	Automate approval and request tracking for standard laptops	Service Management

3. Problem Identification

The existing IT procurement process for standard laptops involves manual activities and may cause delays in configuration and task assignment.

The major problems identified are:

- Manual handling of standard laptop requests.
- Delay in laptop configuration after arrival.
- Manual assignment of tasks to the Hardware team.
- Possibility of oversight or errors during the procurement process.

- Increased user waiting time.
- Inefficient utilisation of IT resources.

These issues are identified in the project documentation.

4. Idea Prioritization

The ideas were evaluated based on **Feasibility** and **Importance**, following the provided prioritization template.

Group No.	Final Idea	Feasibility	Importance	Priority Selected
1	Automate standard laptop procurement workflow	High	High	Yes
2	Automatically create catalog tasks after approval	High	High	Yes
3	Automatically assign tasks to Hardware team	High	High	Yes
4	Automate approval and request tracking	Medium	High	Yes
5	Reduce manual intervention using Flow Designer	High	High	Yes

5. Selected Project Idea

Selected Idea:

Automating Standard Laptop Orders using ServiceNow Flow Designer

The selected idea is to create an automated workflow that generates a Catalog Task after the laptop request is approved and assigns the task to the Hardware team for configuration.

This directly supports the project's objective of reducing manual intervention, improving task allocation, and providing timely laptop configuration.

6. Project Objectives

The project aims to:

1. Automate the standard laptop procurement workflow.
 2. Automatically create a Catalog Task after approval.
 3. Assign the configuration task to the Hardware team.
 4. Reduce manual intervention and possible errors.
 5. Reduce user waiting time.
 6. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department.
 7. Improve the overall efficiency of the IT procurement process.
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7. Planned Workflow

Standard Laptop Request

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Service Catalog

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User places Standard Laptop Order

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Approval

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Flow Designer Trigger

↓

Create Catalog Task

↓

Assign to Hardware Group

↓

Laptop Configuration

↓

Task Status Updated

8. Planning Milestones

Milestone 1 – Flow Creation

Create a Flow Designer flow named “**Standard Laptop Task**”.

The flow will:

- Use Service Catalog as the trigger.
- Create a Catalog Task.
- Update the short description.
- Set the description.
- Assign the task to the **Hardware** group.
- Run after the request is approved.
- Save and activate the flow.

These steps correspond to the implementation described in the project document.

Milestone 2 – Flow Assignment

Assign the created **Standard Laptop Task** flow to the **Standard Laptop Service Catalog** item through Maintain Items and the Process Engine configuration.

Milestone 3 – Service Catalog Testing

Place a Standard Laptop order through the Service Catalog, obtain approval, and verify that the Catalog Task is automatically created and assigned to the Hardware group.

9. Expected Outcome

The planned solution should streamline standard laptop procurement by automating task creation and assignment. This is intended to reduce manual overhead, minimise waiting time, improve resource allocation, and provide a more efficient procurement experience.

10. Final Planning Decision

Final Project Idea:

“Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer.”

Priority: Yes

Feasibility: High

Importance: High